

Red Ranger 3

Phase 2 opens with the Red Ranger line. It plays the role *Iron Man 3* played for Marvel: the hero loses his armor and has to find out what he is without it.

Field	Detail
Release date	Friday, August 24, 2018, the weekend before the 25th anniversary of MMPR's premiere (August 28, 2018)
Distributor	20th Century Fox (a Disney company after the 2018 acquisition)
Rating / runtime	PG-13 / 157 minutes
Real title	Red Ranger 3
Decoy title	Desert Bloom
Whose film it is	Rocky DeSantos, the Red Ranger. The Red Ranger line follows the mantle Jason passed to him in <i>Power Rangers</i> .

WHY THIS CHARACTER AND THIS DATE

Rocky inherits the line, and the anniversary weekend.

- **Jason is at the World Peace Conference, as in canon.** He isn't in Angel Grove during this era, so the Red Ranger line follows the color, exactly as the Power Transfer passed it. Jason's own return is saved for his canon comeback as the Gold Ranger, which closes this phase.
- **It's an Iron Man 3 arc.** Rocky inherited a mantle he isn't sure he deserves. Then Rito Revolto destroys the Thunderzords and cripples the team's power, so Rocky has to prove himself without the armor.
- **The date:** the 25th-anniversary weekend, a Red Ranger tradition. It's clear of *Mission: Impossible – Fallout* (July 27) and the summer tentpoles.

01 • TITLE: REAL AND DECOY

Red Ranger 3, shot as Desert Bloom

- **Real title:** *Red Ranger 3*.
- **Decoy title:** *Desert Bloom*. It reads like a coming-of-age drama and quietly hides the Desert of Despair.

02 • WHOSE FILM IT IS

Rocky DeSantos, the Red Ranger

- Rocky's first lead role: the funny, big-hearted martial artist from Stone Canyon who has to grow into Jason's color.
- **Faithfulness lock:** Tommy stays the team's leader, as in canon. Rocky's arc is about earning the Red, not taking over command. Billy, Adam, Aisha and Kimberly are all at full strength.

03 • WHEN AND WHERE IT'S SET

MGU Year Two into Year Three: winter 2014–15

- **When:** a few months after the Power Transfer.
- **Where:** Angel Grove, the Moon palace, the Command Center, and the **Temple of Power in the Desert of Despair**.

04 • WHAT IT'S ABOUT

No armor. No Zords. Just Rocky.

- **Act one, the wedding:** Rita's dumpster finally lands. She slips Lord Zedd a love potion and the two marry, as in canon. Evil is now a family business.
- **The gift:** Rita's brother **Rito Revolto** arrives. He's a bumbling, laughing skeleton who looks like a joke. That's the twist on *Iron Man 3*'s Mandarin: Rito looks harmless and turns out to be devastating. With Goldar and the new **Tenga Warriors**, he **destroys the Thunderzords** and leaves the Rangers' powers crippled.
- **The quest:** Zordon sends the team to **Ninjor**, creator of the Power Coins, at the Temple of Power. Rocky, who has never felt he earned the Red, has to lead his part of the quest and stand on his own in the Desert of Despair.
- **Climax:** Ninjor gives the team the **Ninja Power Coins** and the **Ninjazords**: Red Ape, Black Frog, Blue Wolf, Yellow Bear, Pink Crane and White Falcon. Rocky leads the Ninja Megazord's first battle against Rito's monster, and Ninjor grows to giant size to fight beside them.
- **Ending:** Rocky has earned the color. The Red Ranger line is his now, while it lasts.

05 • VILLAIN / ANTAGONIST

Rito Revolto

- **Rito Revolto**, Rita's brother, at full canon strength. He destroyed the Thunderzords, and the film keeps that feat. Lord Zedd and Rita, now married, rule the Moon. Goldar, Finster, Squatt, Baboo and the Tenga Warriors back them up.

06 • POST-CREDITS SCENES

Two scenes

- **Mid-credits: “The New Girl.”** Through her telescope, Rita spots a new student at Angel Grove High, **Katherine Hillard**, and smiles. This sets up *White Ranger 2*.
- **End-credits: “The Letter.”** At Ernie's, Rocky reads a postcard from Switzerland: “*Take care of the Red. – J.*”

07 • SETTING UP THE BIG BAD

Ninjor is afraid

- Billy shows Ninjor the deep-space signal he logged in *Blue Ranger*. Ninjor, who forged the Power Coins themselves, goes silent and says only: “Do not go looking for him.” A being older than the coins fears the watcher.
- Rito shows that evil in this universe is a dynasty, with Rita's family reaching back to Master Vile. That's the bloodline that feeds into the United Alliance of Evil.

08 • ITS OWN WORLD-BUILDING

The Ninja world

- Ninjor, the Temple of Power, the Desert of Despair, the Ninja Coins, the six Ninjazords and the Ninja Megazord, and Rocky's life as the new Red.

09 • MGU WORLD-BUILDING

The rules every later film builds on

- **The Power Coins have a maker.** Ninjor is the first being shown to have forged Grid power.
- **Rita and Zedd's marriage** unites the Moon for the rest of the MMPR era.
- **Rito and the Tenguas** are now recurring threats.

10 • ITS ROLE IN PHASE 2

How it opens the phase

- It shows the MGU can lose its original lead and keep going. The mantle matters more than any one person, and it rebuilds the team with Ninja power for the rest of Phase 2.

This is a fictional, alternate-history development document created for creative purposes. Characters and events follow the original Power Rangers television series (Mighty Morphin through Zeo).